

TEACHER'S VERSION — answers, model answers and teaching notes are printed in red.

PART A: PROOFREADING (6 SENTENCES)

Proofread the following sentences. Each sentence contains TWO errors. Most of the mistakes come from Lesson 3's sentence patterns.

1. There is an urgent need for the government to investing in free sports facilities, as young people is losing interest in outdoor activities.
2. To improving employees' mental health, the company should make it a priority to hold a short team meeting every Monday, which in turn help staff to share their workload.
3. Managers, in collaboration of the human resources team, should encourage their staff taking a proper lunch break away from the desk.
4. The government should make it a priority to raise graduate awareness of the skills that employers need, because many fresh graduates lacks practical experience.
5. To cut company cost, managers should make it a priority to reduce overtime hours and allowing staff to work from home twice a week.
6. Admittedly, the elderlies in our community benefit from regular visits; nevertheless, most employees rarely volunteers their free time.

TEACHER'S ANSWERS (LESSON 4, PART A)

Item	Corrected sentence	The TWO errors and why
1	There is an urgent need for the government to invest in free sports facilities, as young people are losing interest in outdoor activities.	(a) Verb form: "to investing" → "to invest" — Lesson 3, Pattern 1 takes TO + the base verb ("for the government to invest"). (b) Agreement: "young people is" → "young people are" — "people" is plural.

2	To improve employees' mental health, the company should make it a priority to hold a short team meeting every Monday, which in turn helps staff to share their workload.	(a) Verb form: "To improving" → "To improve" — Lesson 3, Pattern 2 opens with TO + the base verb to state the goal. (b) Agreement: "which in turn help" → "helps" — the relative clause takes a singular verb (the meeting helps).
3	Managers, in collaboration with the human resources team, should encourage their staff to take a proper lunch break away from the desk.	(a) Preposition: "in collaboration of" → "in collaboration with" — Lesson 3, Pattern 3 is a fixed phrase. (b) Verb pattern: "encourage their staff taking" → "encourage their staff to take" — encourage + object + TO + base verb.
4	The government should make it a priority to raise graduates' awareness of the skills that employers need, because many fresh graduates lack practical experience.	(a) Possessive form: "graduate awareness" → "graduates' awareness" (the awareness belongs to the graduates). (b) Agreement: "many fresh graduates lacks" → "lack" — a plural subject takes the base verb.
5	To cut company costs, managers should make it a priority to reduce overtime hours and allow staff to work from home twice a week.	(a) Noun number: "company cost" → "company costs" — costs are countable here. (b) Parallel form: "and allowing" → "and allow" — the two verbs after "to" must match ("to reduce ... and allow ...").
6	Admittedly, the elderly in our community benefit from regular visits; nevertheless, most employees rarely volunteer their free time.	(a) Word form: "the elderlies" → "the elderly" — "the elderly" is already plural (Lesson 3, Set 6). (b) Agreement: "most employees rarely volunteers" → "volunteer" — plural subject, base verb.

PART B: UPGRADING VOCABULARY

Topic: the workplace. The six upgrades below are the words you will need in Part D.

#	Basic	Upgraded
1	<i>The company <u>loses many young employees every year</u>.</i>	struggles to retain young talent
2	<i>Managers should <u>praise employees when they do a good job</u>.</i>	recognise employees' contributions
3	<i>Employees can <u>do their jobs from home on some days</u>.</i>	work remotely on a hybrid schedule
4	<i>Bosses often <u>send messages to staff at night</u>.</i>	contact staff outside office hours

5	<i>Some companies <u>do not pay employees for the extra hours they work</u>.</i>	leave overtime unpaid
6	<i>New staff are given work but <u>no training</u>.</i>	no induction or mentoring

PART C: UPGRADING SENTENCE (FOUR WAYS TO GIVE EXAMPLES)

THE BASIC EXAMPLES STUDENTS USUALLY WRITE

For example, many workers work long hours and this is bad for their health.

For example, many workers answer messages at night and they cannot rest well.

For example, a worker has to work late and he cannot have dinner with his family.

For example, some countries have laws to protect workers.

Way 1 — Findings (a named study)

Target Formula: According to [source] ([year]), [finding].

Basic:	For example, many workers work long hours and this is bad for their health.
Upgraded:	According to a 2021 WHO and ILO study , working 55 hours or more a week raises the risk of stroke by 35% .

Teaching note: “According to” + a NAMED source + the year is the whole formula — never “studies show”, and never a number you have invented. WHO = World Health Organization, ILO = International Labour Organization. Learn ONE finding for the topic and you own this way.

Way 2 — Typical Process

Target Formula: Consider what happens when + [situation]: + [step 1 → step 2 → result].

Basic:	For example, many workers answer messages at night and they cannot rest well.
Upgraded:	Consider what happens when a worker answers one message at bedtime: the phone stays on the pillow, the mind keeps drafting replies, and the night’s sleep is gone.

Teaching note: No source and no name needed — the safety net when you remember no facts. Three moves (first this, then that, so the harm), and the last move must be the damage you are arguing about. Keep it general: one named person makes it Way 3.

Way 3 — Hypothetical Scene

Target Formula: Imagine + [a worker in an ordinary moment] + [what happens next] + [so what].

Basic:	For example, a worker has to work late and he cannot have dinner with his family.
Upgraded:	Imagine a clerk who leaves the office at nine every evening: by the time he gets home, his daughter is asleep and his dinner is cold.

Teaching note: Give the marker a scene they can SEE: one worker, one place, one object (a cold dinner, a phone, a desk lamp). Write “Imagine a clerk ...”, never “Imagine if you ...” — the essay bans “you”. No numbers in the scene: they read as fake statistics.

Way 4 — Real-world Example	
Target Formula: In + [month year], + [who did what] + — evidence that + [point].	
Basic:	For example, some countries have laws to protect workers.
Upgraded:	In August 2024, Australia gave workers the right to ignore work messages after hours — evidence that even governments treat this as a problem.

Teaching note: One real event, dated, with the country named, plus the little “evidence that ...” clause that ties it back to your argument. France did the same in January 2017 for companies with fifty or more staff. Never invent an event.

Teacher’s note on the design: today’s four ways are a MENU, not four rules. The marker’s test is simple — can I picture it, and does it prove the point? — not “did you cite something?”. Way 1 is the strongest but needs a memorised finding; Ways 2 and 3 need no reading at all. ONE way per example: two ways in one paragraph reads as two examples and usually loses the round-off. Keep the “because” workings in [Explain] — an example illustrates, it does not explain. Every upgraded line above stays ONE simple sentence on purpose: the pattern must be easy to copy, not impressive to read.

PART D: REWRITING EXERCISE (PRACTICE SETS)

Rewrite each weak example with the way shown, and use the way exactly as taught in Part C. The topics are different from the working-hours topic in Part C. Sets 4–6 are more challenging: the box gives a topic sentence AND a weak example, so you must rewrite the example and finish the paragraph with a [Round off].

Set 1. Topic: Keeping Young Staff

Weak example	For example, the company loses many young employees every year.
Use Way 1	According to Gallup’s 2023 State of the Global Workplace report, 51% of employees worldwide are watching for or actively seeking a new job.

Key note: Any correctly framed finding is accepted (source + year + figure) — the figures here are real. Part B tells you what to call the problem: the company struggles to retain young talent.

Set 2. Topic: Recognising Good Work

Weak example	For example, managers do not praise employees when they do a good job.
Use Way 2	Consider what happens when praise never comes: the extra effort goes unnoticed, the worker stops helping with the difficult tasks, and a good employee quietly becomes an average one.

Key note: Accept any clear three-move process (first ... then ... so that ...); the last move must be the harm. Part B: managers should recognise employees’ contributions.

Set 3. Topic: Working from Home

Weak example	For example, employees do their jobs from home on some days, but they cannot switch off.
Use Way 3	Imagine a sales executive whose office is now the kitchen table: one email is answered while the kettle boils, another during dinner, and by ten o’clock the laptop is still open.

Key note: Accept any scene with one worker, one place and one object; the last detail must show the harm. Part B: employees work remotely on a hybrid schedule.

Set 4. Topic: Messages After Office Hours (more challenging)

Topic sentence	The company should stop contacting staff outside office hours.
Weak example	For example, some companies have already made rules about this.
Use Way 4 + [Round off]	In January 2017, France required companies with fifty or more staff to agree rules on out-of-hours contact — evidence that even governments treat constant availability as a problem. A manager who waits until morning sends the same instruction and keeps a colleague, and that habit costs the company nothing.

Key note: The dated event replaces the vague generalisation, and the round-off echoes the question’s wording (“work messages after office hours”).

Set 5. Topic: Overtime That Is Never Paid (more challenging)

Topic sentence	Companies should not leave overtime unpaid.
Weak example	For example, workers do extra work but they do not get any money for it.
Use Way 2 + [Round off]	Consider what happens when the extra hours are never recorded: the first hour is given “just this once”, the second becomes expected, and by the end of the year the team is working a seventh day for the same salary. Overtime that nobody counts is the quietest way a company takes from its staff.

Key note: Accept any three-move process. The round-off must return to the unpaid hours, not to “overtime in general”.

Set 6. Topic: Help for New Graduates (more challenging)

Topic sentence	Employers should provide proper induction and mentoring for new staff.
Weak example	For example, new staff are given work but no training.
Use Way 3 + [Round off]	Imagine a graduate in her first month who is given a client’s whole account and a one-line brief: she works until midnight, repeats the same mistakes, and learns only that the office is a lonely place. Patience with a new colleague in the first year is how a company grows its own experts instead of buying them.

Key note: The scene must be about the graduates themselves, and the round-off must echo the question’s key words. Part B: give new staff induction and mentoring.

PART E: WRITING PRACTICE

HKDSE adapted Paper 2 prompt (Workplace Communication — based on DSE 2018 Paper 2 Part B):

You are the boss of Reboot Online Company and you have recently received complaints from some staff about the number of work-related emails and text messages received out of office. Write a letter to staff addressing their complaints.

Task requirements:

Make ONE suggestion (about 100 words) about reducing the number of work-related messages staff receive outside office hours, and open your paragraph with ONE of Lesson 3’s three patterns as the topic sentence.

Follow the chain: [Topic sentence] → [Explain] → [Example — using ONE of today’s four ways] → [Round off]. Underline your example and label it (Way 1 / 2 / 3 / 4), so your teacher can see which way you chose.

Teacher’s three suggested paragraphs — any ONE of them answers the task

Suggested paragraph 1 — the company’s policy (Pattern 1 + Way 1: findings)

There is an urgent need for Reboot Online to stop contacting staff outside office hours. [Topic sentence — Pattern 1]The problem is not a real emergency; it is the ordinary message that arrives at ten o’clock at night. It can wait until morning, yet it keeps the employee half at work — and long hours are what damage health.

[Explain]According to a 2021 WHO and ILO study, working 55 hours or more a week raises the risk of stroke by 35%. [Example — Way 1: findings]A rule that protects our

evenings costs the company nothing, and staff who are not tired are worth far more than a message sent at midnight. [Round off]

Suggested paragraph 2 — the team meeting (Pattern 2 + Way 4: real-world example)

To give every colleague back their private time, Reboot Online should make it a priority to agree an out-of-hours contact policy with the whole team. [Topic sentence — Pattern 2]A vague promise does not survive a busy month, but a written rule tells every manager when a message cannot wait and when it can. [Explain]In August 2024, Australia gave workers the right to ignore work messages after hours — evidence that even governments treat constant availability as a problem. [Example — Way 4: real-world example]A company that writes the rule down keeps its best people, and keeping them costs far less than replacing them. [Round off]

Suggested paragraph 3 — the managers (Pattern 3 + Way 3: hypothetical scene)

Managers, in collaboration with the staff they lead, should agree on one hour each evening when nobody is expected to reply. [Topic sentence — Pattern 3]Respect is shown in small habits: a team that knows when it may switch off plans its day better and stops taking its work home. [Explain]Imagine a clerk at Reboot Online who leaves the office at seven: because his manager keeps everything that can wait until morning, he gets home for dinner and comes back with something left to give. [Example — Way 3: hypothetical scene]A few quiet hours cost the company nothing, and staff who arrive rested do better work. [Round off]

Teacher's note: each paragraph makes ONE suggestion and uses ONE example way — the topic sentence is the only place where a Lesson 3 pattern is required, and the example is the only place where a way is required. Models 2 and 3 need no memorised facts; Model 1 does. If a student hands in Way 2, check that the last move states the harm; if a student hands in Way 4, check that the event is real, dated and tied back with “evidence that ...”.

What to reward when marking

Content: ONE clear, workable suggestion for cutting out-of-hours messages, developed with a mechanism and proved with ONE example — not three ideas.

Language: the topic sentence uses ONE Lesson 3 pattern accurately; the example names its source or builds its scene, with no invented figures, names or events.

Organisation: [Topic sentence] → [Explain] → [Example] → [Round off], with the round-off echoing the words of the question (“work-related emails and text messages received out of office”).